

Lesson 1: Where We Are

Student Guide · Middle School

Name: _____

Date: _____

Period: _____

In this lesson, Agent Kodak explains where the Nolan Xavier Wells case stands right now and what can still happen next.

01 Watch and fill in

Fill in the blanks while you watch the video.

1. Nolan Xavier Wells died after a trip to _____ Island on July 4, 2026.
2. On September 21, the _____ said "no true bill."
3. "No true bill" means no _____.
4. The grand jury process included 132 _____ and 43 witnesses.
5. The state's medical examiner said the cause of death could not be _____.
6. Mississippi has no time _____ on murder charges.

02 Vocabulary

Write the letter of the matching meaning next to each word.

Word	Letter	Word	Letter
Autopsy		No true bill	
Grand jury		Medical examiner	
Undetermined		Evidence	

- A. A group of citizens who decide in private if there is enough evidence to charge someone.
- B. The grand jury's decision that there is not enough evidence to charge anyone right now.
- C. Facts or items that help show what happened.
- D. A medical exam after someone dies to learn what happened.
- E. A doctor who performs autopsies.
- F. Could not be decided with the evidence available.

03 Who does what?

Two are done for you. Fill in the rest. Use the video or the map if you need help.

Position	What is their job?
Sheriff	Investigates deaths outside city limits and gathers the evidence others will review.
Coroner	
State Medical Examiner	
District Attorney (DA)	
Grand Jury	Citizens who decide in private whether there is enough evidence to charge someone. 12 must agree.

04 Think about it

"No true bill" is not the same as "not guilty." Why do you think that difference matters?

If you wanted to learn more about what happened, what is one record or source you would want to see? Why?

05 Exit ticket

Name one office that was part of this case and one thing that office does.



Learn more on your own time

Scan to open the interactive map for Lesson 1. Tap the lit-up offices, hover the **i** terms, read the sources and take the quiz.

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